

***A standard library* is the set of tools included in a language's standard installation. The library includes core data structures and tools for working with data in your program.**

Python's standard library includes tools to help you:

- Work with a variety of data types and text
- Use mathematical functions
- Work with files and dates and times
- Make graphical user interfaces (GUIs)
- Work with networks and multimedia
- Test and debug your code and handle errors
- Distribute your programs

Seldom does a standard library include specialized data analysis tools, game frameworks, web application frameworks, and other application-specific libraries. These are available through external libraries that are updated more often than the language as a whole.

Once you understand a language's core syntax and rules, become familiar with the language's standard library tools as these can help you write code efficiently.